

desk takes the mobile number and through the application, generates an OTP or registers a missed call. The application then generates a one-time visitor pass."

Security systems at gates can be enhanced as well. Vivish Technologies has released myGate application. Aimed primarily at gated apartments as well as business areas, the multi-tiered setup can be configured at the entry gate of the campus as well as at the gates of separate buildings. Thus it makes recording entries and exits easier and error-free. In case of any security concern, the security suite can raise alarms. The myGate team claims the technology is based on behavioural-intelligence-augmented authentication.

Keeping a tab on vehicles around the campus is also essential. While in-house vehicles can be tracked with separate tracking solutions, myGate can help manage visitor vehicles and follow their whereabouts around the campus.

As regards contractual staff management, Maheswari says, "As contractual employees usually are outsourced by a third party, they are not provided any proper employee ID or authentication access by the company. This makes accountability and traceability of the staff nearly impossible." That is something modern-day solutions are solving as well. Applications can be used to store records pertaining to the staff and assign specific identification numbers to each of them. Their whereabouts can be updated and tracked following their enrollment in the application.

Most small- and medium-scale companies do not invest in tracking couriers (whether inbound or outbound) on campus. For received packages, applications like 'All Is Well' can scan the item within the package, store package data and forward the package to the intended recipient. These also act as a tracker system for outbound packages.

Maheswari says, "Companies should keep track of the packages they receive or dispatch for better safety protocols. The same can be said for various factories and industries, where material movement takes

place at large. Systems like ours can keep a consistent record to help in optimal and secure material management."

Apart from these, smart security cameras have replaced conventional cameras. Life-safety alarms, fire alarms and central monitors are essential additions for critical purposes. Taking strong cybersecurity steps is also essential.

The most important characteristic of all these solutions is connectivity to the cloud. Data collected through the hardware or the application is pushed to cloud server. It can be fetched whenever needed—be it for any follow-up protocol or for investigations.

Investment, payback and challenges

Security investment is variable depending on the scale and criticality of the business. While investment in hardware may be done as per one's budget and space available, digital services require nominal investment. Most of these technologies work on pay-as-you-go subscription model.

Maheswari informs, "The cost varies from ₹ 5000 to ₹ 15,000 per month for each unit installed. Since minimal hardware is involved in these setups, maintenance cost is also negligible. There are no running costs other than the monthly subscriptions."

So what is the learning curve? Maheswari answers, "Digital media has made these processes very simple. It takes almost no time for the users to learn. We arrange for hands-on training of the users in enterprises. As such, there is no challenge in using these systems. The only challenge may come if any enterprise undergoes frequent changes in security or reception staff—in which case, training has to be arranged every time the staff is changed."

The return on investment is not just in terms of finances. "It is an insurance. Imagine the loss in terms of resources, brand image as well as finance if any employee becomes a victim of security issues. Imagine the scope of loss of essential business assets or information if a package or material is misplaced. All this can

be prevented with stronger security upgrades," Maheswari says.

Digital modes are emerging as the best solutions for the safety of employees and assets. With better security suites coming out, it is the only way we walk towards a safer tomorrow.

—Paromik Chakraborty, technical journalist, EYF

Driverless Cars: Automotive Sector's Next Big Business Bet

► In probably ten years it will be very unusual for cars to be built that are not fully autonomous

Automotive technology is changing faster than ever. Automakers like Tesla, BMW, Audi and General Motors are leading the race to manufacture connected vehicles of the future. While driverless cars are expected to arrive on road by 2021, there are still apprehensions about the desired infrastructure development and evolution of macro sensors technology.

Data will play a significant role in the development of driverless vehicles, for how else are these going to learn? But how is the business model going to change? Who will have more power and control over the vehicles: OEMs or ICT partners? Who will own the data: Channel partners, companies or end consumers? Will the traditional model of selling the cars to end consumers continue to triumph, or will the new monthly/yearly service model take over? Or, will car aggregators like Uber win the game?

The technology is still evolving for